

Beef and Sheep Production

Science

May, 2026

Beef and Sheep Production (A13743)

Short Title: Beef and Sheep Production
Faculty Science and Computing
Department Science
Cluster Agriculture
Author SWALSH
Credits 5

Level: Introductory

Description of Module / Aims

This module will enable the student to gain a comprehensive knowledge of and the skills required to manage beef and sheep production systems. It will enable the student to appraise the physical and financial aspects of the cattle and sheep industry. It will also allow the student to produce cattle and sheep in line with animal welfare and environmental regulations.

Programmes

PROD-0005 BSc (Hons) in Agricultural Science (WD_SAGRI_B)

2 / 4 / M

Indicative Content

- Beef production systems and evaluation of financial returns
- Examination of housing and handling facilities for bovines
- Examination of bovine health, nutrition and breeding
- Sheep production systems and evaluation of financial returns
- Examination of housing and handling facilities for sheep
- Examination of sheep health, nutrition and breeding

Learning Outcomes

On successful completion of this module, a student will be able to:

1. Describe the feeding and management requirements of beef cattle and sheep production.
2. Describe the main markets, market requirements and financial returns from beef and sheep production.
3. Describe the types of housing and handling facilities for the main beef and sheep enterprises.
4. Complete safely routine skills associated with the operation of a cattle and sheep enterprise with due regard to good environmental practice and the animal's health and welfare.
5. Describe good environmental practices in animal production.
6. Describe appropriate actions to promote and maintain animal good health and welfare.

Learning and Teaching Methods

- Lectures.
- Practical instruction, including participation in flock and herd management.

Assessment Methods

	Weighing	Outcomes Assessed
Final Written Examination	50%	1,2,3,5,6
Continuous Assessment	50%	
<i>Practical</i>	40%	4
<i>Assignment</i>	10%	3,6

Assessment Criteria

<40%: Very limited knowledge and understanding of the subject matter.

40%-49%: Demonstrate a limited knowledge of the subject matter. May have some problems with critical thinking and problem-solving.

50%-59%: As well as the above, the student will be able to demonstrate an understanding of some of the complexities of the topics.

60%-69%: In addition, the student will demonstrate more detailed knowledge of the all topics and demonstrate an ability to evaluate detailed knowledge acquired in the module to new material.

70%-100%: The learner will be able to demonstrate comprehensive knowledge and understanding of all learning outcomes, and an ability to evaluate and relate topics that overlap all of the learning outcomes.

Note:

- In addition to the normal regulations, a minimum of 35% must be achieved in both the final exam and continuous assessment components of the module. In cases where continuous assessment has a practical component attendance of at least 75% in the practicals is mandatory.

Learning Modes

Learning Mode	F/T Hours	P/T Hours
Lecture	24	
Practical	24	
Independent Learning	87	

Supplementary Material

- "Animal Health Ireland." <http://www.ahi.ie>
- "Irish Cattle Breeding Federation." www.icbf.com. <http://icbf.com>
- "Sheep Ireland." www.sheep.ie
- "Teagasc." www.teagasc.ie. <http://www.teagasc.ie>
- Diskin, M.G. and M.P. McHugh, eds. *Technical Updates on Sheep Production*. Ireland: Teagasc, 2012.
- Moore, M., ed. *Teagasc Beef Manual*. Ireland: Teagasc, 2012.
- O'Dwyer, J. *Beef Production Workbook*. Ireland: Teagasc, 2011.
- O'Dwyer, J. *Sheep Production Workbook*. Ireland: Teagasc, 2012.
- Straiton, E. *Sheep Ailments: Recognition and Treatment*. UK: The Crowood Press Ltd., 2015.
- Webster, J. *Management and Welfare of Farm Animals*. UK: Wiley & Sons, 2011.
- Willis, M.B. and C. Dalton. *Introduction to Practical Animal Breeding*. 4th ed. UK: Wiley, 1998.